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LEGAL DUE DILIGENCE REPORT

Project Granite — Proposed acquisition of Calder Vale Foods Limited

Prepared by Whitfield Carter LLP for Wexford Holdings Limited | 30 October 2025 | STRICTLY PRIVATE & CONFIDENTIAL — SUBJECT TO LEGAL PRIVILEGE

1. Important notice

This report has been prepared by Whitfield Carter LLP solely for Wexford Holdings Limited (the "Buyer") in connection with the proposed acquisition of the entire issued share capital of Calder Vale Foods Limited (the "Target"). It is based on the documents made available in the data room as at 28 October 2025 and the Sellers' written and oral replies to our enquiries. It is subject to legal professional privilege, must not be disclosed to any third party without our prior written consent, and is given on the basis set out in our engagement letter dated 12 September 2025. We have not verified the accuracy of the information provided and have assumed that all copy documents are complete and conform to their originals.

2. Executive summary

The Target is a profitable chilled-foods manufacturer incorporated in England and Wales (no. 05583120) and wholly owned by Robert Calder (65%), Helen Calder (20%) and the Calder Family Trust (15%). Our review has not identified any matter that we consider to be a fundamental impediment to the Acquisition at the agreed enterprise value of £45,000,000. We have, however, identified three red-flag items and a number of lower-priority points which should be addressed through specific provisions in the Share Purchase Agreement, the Disclosure Letter or post-completion undertakings, as summarised below and developed in the body of this report.

Ref	Issue	Risk	Recommended action
RF-1	Northborough Dairies supply agreement (dated 1 April 2023) contains a change-of-control termination right exercisable on 30 days' notice.	High	Obtain counterparty consent as a condition or, failing that, a post-completion undertaking and price protection.
RF-2	Open HMRC VAT correspondence on the treatment of promotional rebates for the period to 31 March 2024 (estimated exposure up to £140,000).	Medium	Specific tax indemnity in the SPA; full disclosure in the Disclosure Letter.
RF-3	Employment Tribunal claim by a former employee (ET 3201884/2025) for unfair dismissal.	Low/Med	Warranty, conduct-of-claims provision and existing provision of £15,000; monitor to resolution.

3. Corporate and constitutional

The Target was incorporated on 5 February 2006. Its issued share capital comprises 1,000,000 ordinary shares of £1 each, all fully paid and registered as set out above. The statutory registers are written up to date and the share certificates accord with the register of members. The articles of association are in an

unamended form of the model articles with bespoke pre-emption provisions on transfer; the Sellers have agreed to waive those provisions for the purposes of the Acquisition. We recommend that the SPA includes title and capacity warranties and that the transfers be supported by stock transfer forms and board approval of registration. There are no subsisting options, warrants or other rights over the Target's share capital.

4. Accounts and financial

We have reviewed the audited accounts for the years ended 31 December 2022, 2023 and 2024 (audited by Marsden Hale LLP) and the management accounts to 31 October 2025. The accounts are unqualified. The management accounts show trade debtors of £1,180,000 (of which £94,000 is more than 90 days overdue, against which a provision of £60,000 has been made). The financial due diligence (Aldgate Corporate Finance) addresses quality of earnings and the working-capital and net-debt positions, which feed the completion-accounts mechanism in the SPA. We recommend a target working capital of £4,500,000 and a pound-for-pound adjustment, consistent with the heads of terms.

5. Material contracts

The Target's principal customer relationships are with national retailers and its principal supply relationship is the Northborough Dairies supply agreement (RF-1), which is critical to production and contains the change-of-control right noted above. The distribution arrangement with Pennine Cold Chain Limited expires on 31 March 2026 and should be addressed in integration planning. Save for RF-1, we have not identified material change-of-control or onerous-term issues in the contracts reviewed. We recommend warranties as to the absence of defaults and undisclosed change-of-control triggers.

6. Employment and pensions

The Target employs approximately 140 staff. Particulars of the Senior Employees have been disclosed; the Operations Director, Mr Adam Sandhu, is on six months' notice and intends to leave after a transitional period, which should be managed through retention or handover arrangements. The Target operates a defined-contribution pension scheme only, with no defined-benefit exposure. Other than the claim at RF-3, no current or threatened employment disputes have been identified. We recommend standard employment and pensions warranties and a conduct-of-claims provision for RF-3.

7. Property and environment

The Target owns the freehold of Unit 4, Calder Vale Industrial Estate, Skipton (title number NYK284119), subject to a registered charge in favour of Northbank plc to be released at Completion, and holds the Keighley Road cold-store depot under a lease dated 1 May 2019 containing a landlord's break right on 1 May 2027. Our property enquiries and searches have not revealed material adverse matters. Given the nature of the Business we recommend environmental warranties and confirmation of the Target's food-safety and environmental permits, all of which appear to be in force.

8. Intellectual property and IT

The "Calder Vale" trade mark (UK registration no. UK00003456789) is currently registered in the name of Robert Calder personally and should be assigned to the Target at Completion (we have prepared an assignment in the agreed form). The Target's software is licensed under standard terms and we have seen its data-protection policy and ROPA; no material data-protection issues were identified.

9. Tax

Other than the VAT matter at RF-2, the Target's tax affairs appear to be in order. Corporation-tax returns to 31 December 2024 have been filed and the Target is up to date with PAYE, NIC and VAT. We recommend the SPA include a full tax covenant (Schedule 6), tax warranties (Part 6 of Schedule 4) and a specific indemnity in respect of RF-2.

10. Litigation and disputes

Save for the Employment Tribunal claim at RF-3, the Target is not engaged in any material litigation, arbitration or regulatory proceedings, and none is, so far as the Sellers are aware, pending or threatened.

11. Recommendations and next steps

We recommend that the Buyer proceeds with the Acquisition, subject to: (a) reflecting RF-1 to RF-3 in the SPA and Disclosure Letter as set out above; (b) finalising the completion-accounts mechanism; (c) securing the trade-mark assignment and the release of the Northbank charge; and (d) progressing the Northborough Dairies consent. Subject to those matters, we are not aware of any reason why the Buyer should not complete the Acquisition on the agreed terms.

Whitfield Carter LLP | 22 Bishopsgate, London EC2N 4BQ | Lead partner: Sarah Whitfield | 30 October 2025